

platform services, the IBM cloud platform offers an assortment of infrastructure, as well as cognitive software and services to accelerate the pace of application development.

For 2018, our focus will be on IBM Cloud Private (ICP), which was launched last year to enable companies to create on-premise cloud capabilities that are similar to those available on the public cloud, and accelerate app development. ICP delivers a single platform located behind the firewall with which developers can now leverage their on-premise software portfolio and easily integrate next-generation data seamlessly and securely. Additionally, with IBM's new Cloud Private for Data — an integrated data science, data engineering and app building platform — companies can use event-driven applications capable of analysing the torrents of data from IoT sensors, online commerce, mobile devices, and more. The solution helps enterprises manage data storage requirements, while ensuring productivity and cost considerations are optimally balanced. This gives enterprises an option to choose a hybrid cloud model, which uses both on-premise and the public cloud.

Q Are open source technologies supported on the IBM platform?

IBM has a varied portfolio of open technologies such as OpenStack, CloudFoundry, Node.js and OpenWhisk. Today, IBM is also helping to drive an open agenda with the emerging 'born on the cloud' container-based, application development ecosystem, with founding positions in the Open Container Initiative (OCI) and the Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF).

In the blockchain space, we worked with the Linux Foundation to help establish Hyperledger. IBM contributed 44,000 lines

of code and established the first of the Hyperledger projects, Hyperledger Fabric.

Q What about the AI supported services on your platform?

We have a host of AI services on the IBM Watson platform. These include APIs for speech-to-text, text-to-speech and visual recognition. So we have a lot of developers who use that to build things right from chat bots and assistants to virtual agents. The Watson Discovery Service is used to effectively garner insights across multiple data sets, which is helpful for AI developers to infuse AI into their existing applications. Also, using AI is no longer unique these days. Over 50 per cent of applications will have some basic AI capabilities built into them. Not everybody needs to learn how to develop those complicated algorithms; all you need to know is the right AI API for your applications.

“IBM is one of the primary contributors of code to the Hyperledger project, which is run by the Linux Foundation.”

Q What aspects of IoT and the blockchain is IBM looking into?

The IoT space is no doubt growing with every passing day. IBM's Watson IoT platform is one on which multiple devices and sensors are configured and can be used for collective connectivity. We have a very strong set of services on blockchain, based on Hyperledger. IBM is one of the primary contributors of code to the Hyperledger project, which is run

by the Linux Foundation. We have the starter pack and the premium pack of Hyperledger, with which you can build your chain codes and an end-to-end blockchain network, on the cloud. We recently kick-started a countrywide blockchain roadshow and a hackathon in association with NASSCOM, which had several developers participating.

Q What about the offerings for the end users of IoT?

We have a partner ecosystem tapping into a collection of innovative startups and global brands, all working together to solve problems and advance the Internet of Things.

IBM is offering industry-specific applications to help solve specific pain points and tackle opportunities head on. Each IBM Watson IoT industry solution for manufacturing, automotive, electronics, insurance, retail, telecommunications and connected products, offers industry-specific functionality, packaging and analytics.

Q What are the new security provisions you are looking into, after the arrival of the EU's GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation)?

Security and privacy are paramount in the world of IoT. IBM's policies, our business model and the IBM Cloud and Watson architectures all ensure that our clients' data is their data, and their insights are their insights. In a survey conducted by IBM, 39 per cent of global respondents saw the GDPR as a chance to transform their security, privacy and data management efforts, and 20 per cent said it can be a catalyst for new business models. Organisations will use the GDPR to improve their security stance in the long term by enabling a stronger digital strategy and improved efficiency through streamlined data management and increased competitive differentiation. To ensure GDPR readiness, companies will need to embed the processes into their work and make repeated readiness reviews for every product or service. **END** 🐧